

AI Movie Scripts



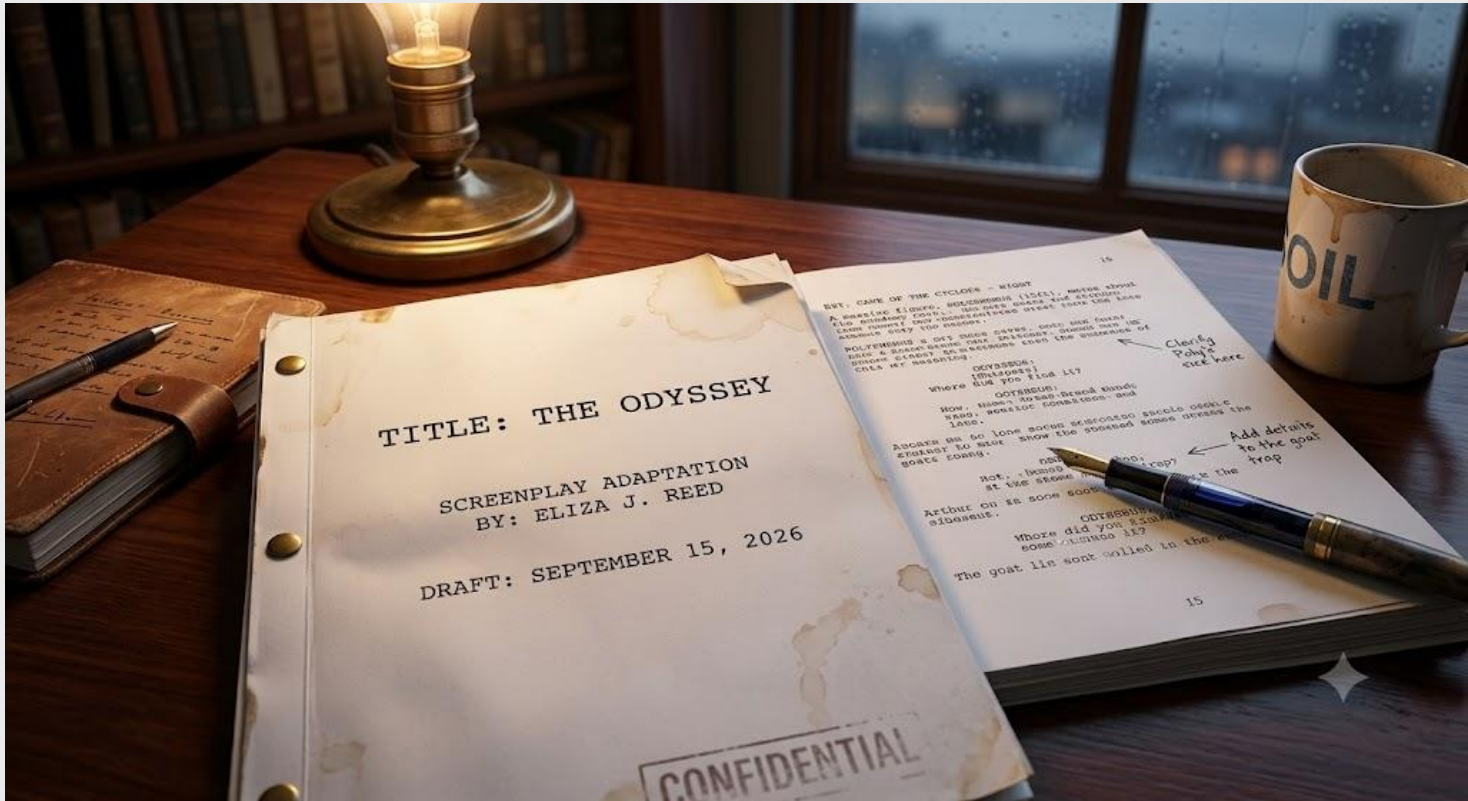
Long-Form Narratives

- A **long-form narrative** is an extended, structurally complex document that maintains context, pacing, and thematic coherence across a sustained output
 - Books, movie scripts, reports, courses
- Today we will build an agentic flow to generate these types of documents
- This flow architecture is general and can be applied to any long-form narrative

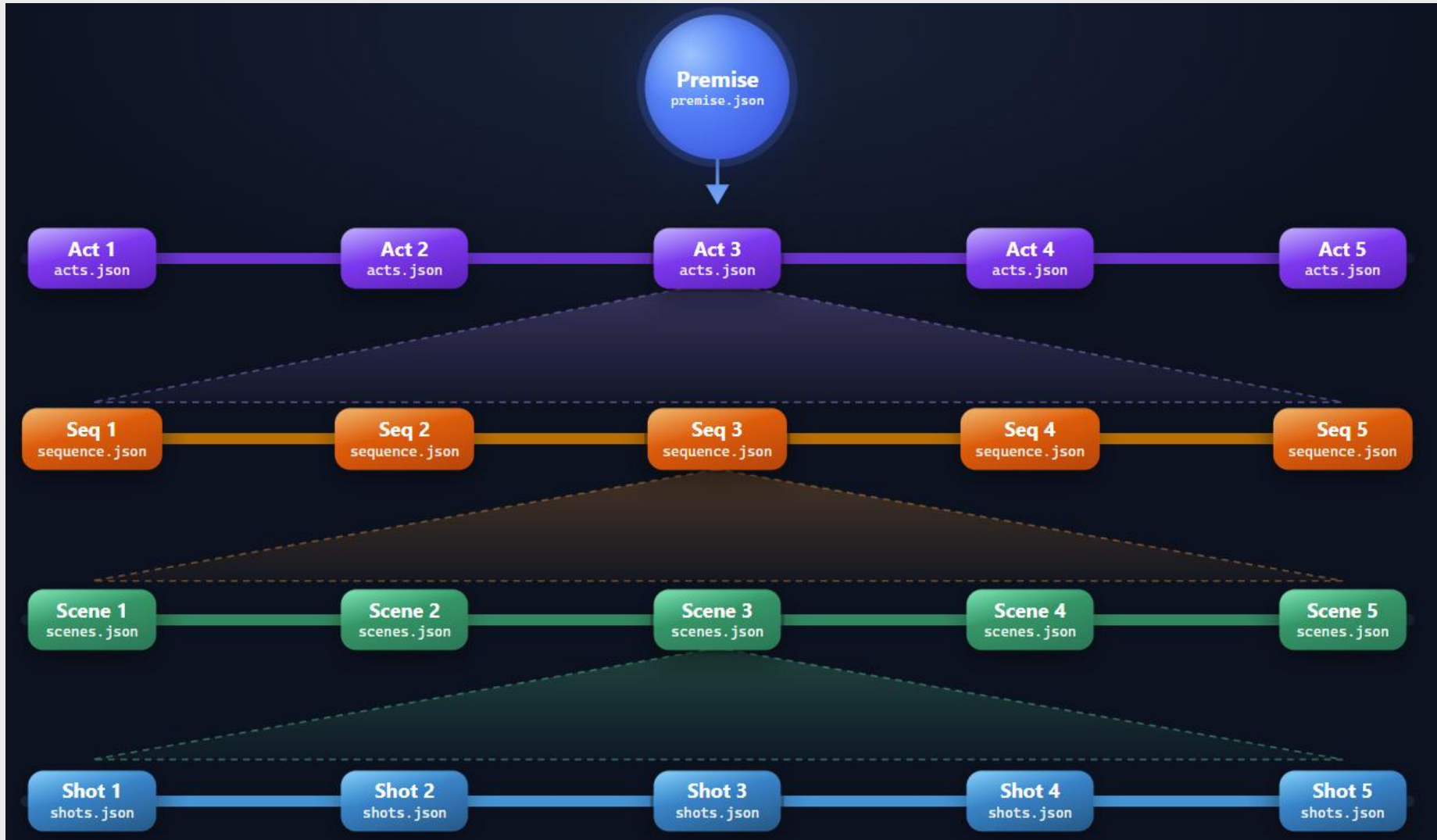
Challenge: One-Shot Long-Form Narratives

- **It is difficult for an AI to generate a long-form narrative in one-shot that is coherent**
- **AI is good at writing short sections, but cannot maintain coherence across the whole document**
 - **Becomes “lost in the middle”**
 - **Context drift – deep into the document, the AI can hallucinate or lose focus of what to write**

Structure of Long-Form Narratives



Structure of Long-Form Narratives



Structure of Long-Form Narratives

- **Level 0 – Foundational Premise**
 - Core identity: Premise, core themes, main characters, and setting
- **Level 1 – Macro Blueprint**
 - High-level narrative architecture and overarching act structure
- **Level 2 – Structural Sections**
 - Major narrative blocks (Chapters, Sequences, or Core Modules)
- **Level 3 – Micro Beats**
 - Step-by-step event progression and individual scene objectives
- **Level 4 – Surface Generation (Prose & Content)**
 - Final output generation: Full paragraphs, dialogue, action lines, or raw text
 - This should be something the AI can create in one shot

Long-Form Narrative Examples

Document	Level 0 Foundation	Level 1 Macro Arc	Level 2 Major Sections	Level 3 Micro Beats	Level 4 Surface Content
Book / Novel	Premise & Lore	Story Arc	Chapter	Scene / Section	Prose & Dialogue
Movie / Screenplay	Logline / Premise	Act Structure	Sequence	Scene	Shot: Action & Dialogue
Video Game	Concept & Lore	Narrative Arc	World / Chapter	Quest / Level	Screens & Dialogue
Podcast / Video	Thesis / Concept	Episode Arc	Segment / Topic	Talking Points	Full Script
Course	Learning Objectives	Modules	Lecture	Subsection	Slides & speaker notes

AI Screenwriting?

- Critics say that AI cannot write long-form narratives like movie screenplays
- However, there are AI models being tested that can write scripts and even generate movie ideas for studios



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AI Screenwriting

POWERING THE FUTURE OF STORYTELLING.



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AI Screenwriting



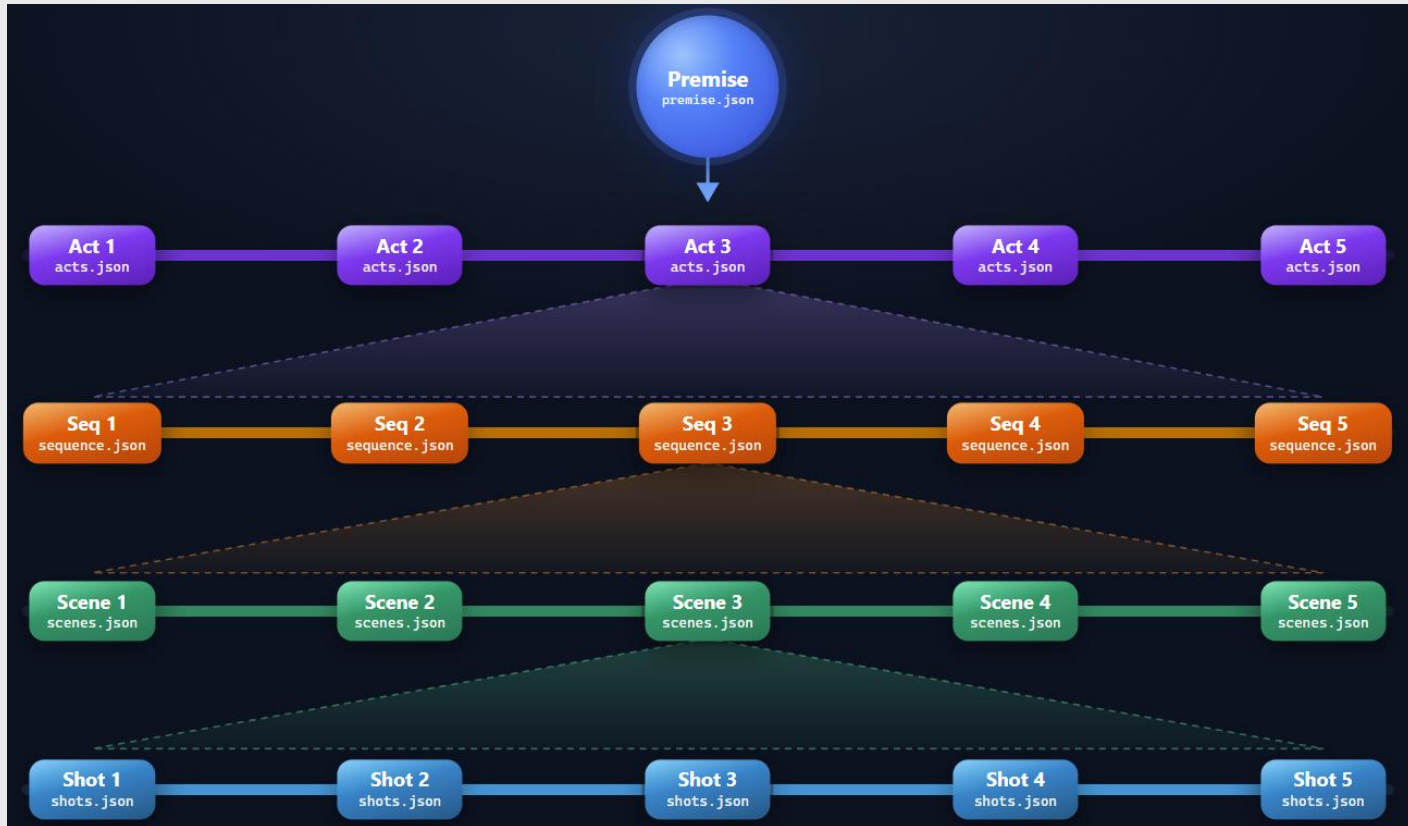
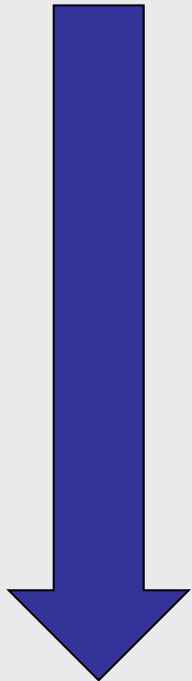
Long-Form Narrative Agent

- We will try to build an agent that can create long-form narratives
- The key will be to design a harness for the agent that respects the **hierarchical structure** of a narrative



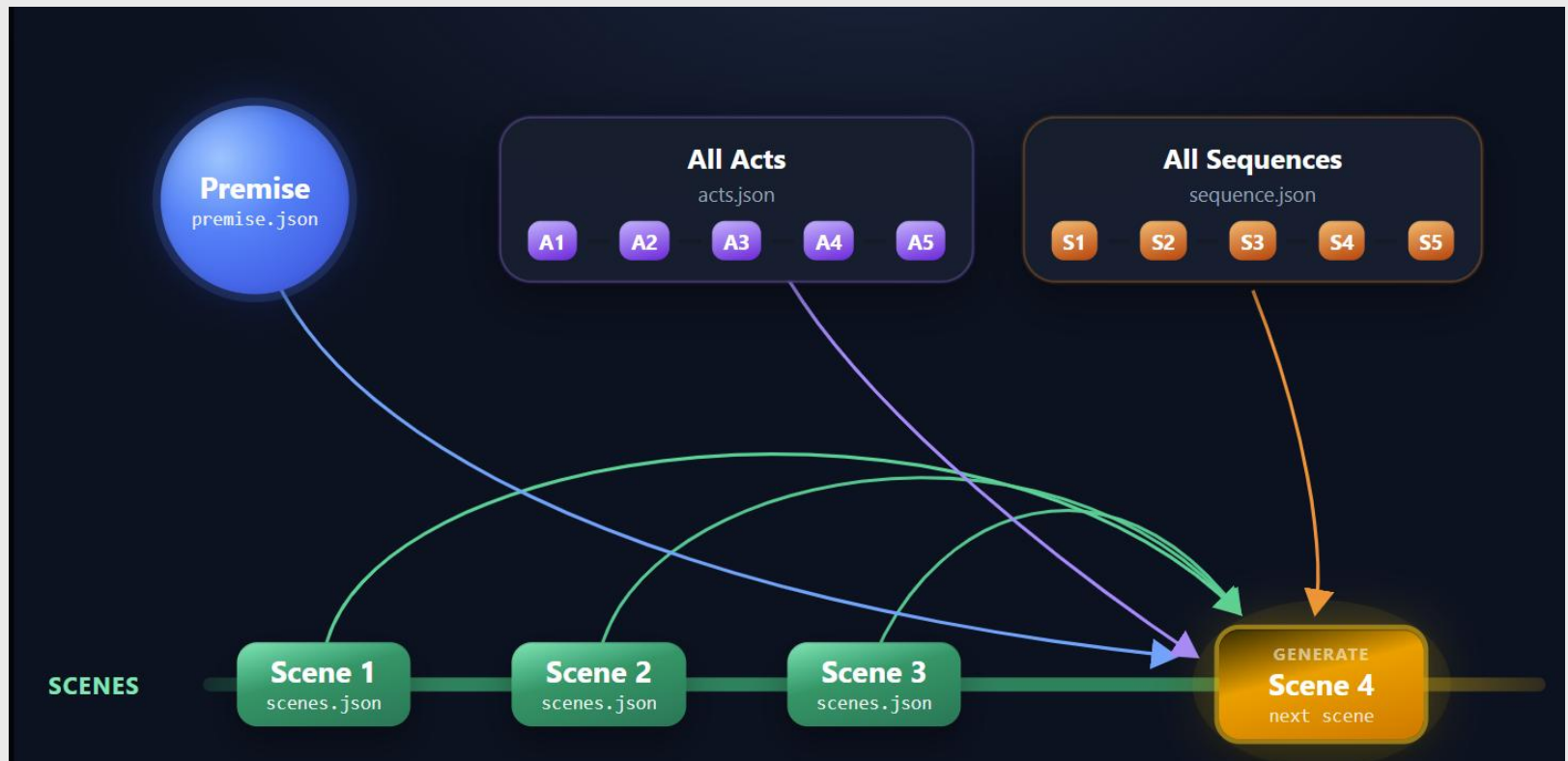
Hierarchical Long-Form Narrative Agent

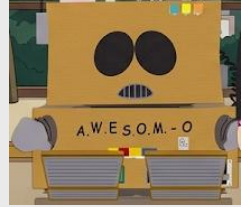
- Long-form narrative agent creates the levels of the hierarchy starting at the top (premise, then acts, then sequences, etc.)



Single Layer Agent Flow

- To create an element in a level of the hierarchy, the agent input is
 - All previous hierarchy levels -> gives global context
 - All previous elements in the current hierarchy -> create smoothness and continuity in the narrative





Level 0 Agent: Premise

- A **chat agent** that discusses with you what your movie is about
 - Title, characters, genre, central conflict
- You can ask the agent to give ideas for the plot if you are stuck
- This chat can take a few minutes even if you have a general sense about your movie (takes time to specify all the major elements of the movie)
- This agent then creates a file **premise.json**

Premise.json

```
{  
  "project_id": "shadow_of_the_dark_world_20260402_025456",  
  "title": "Shadow of the Dark World",  
  "writers": [  
    "TBD"  
  ],  
  "source_script": null,  
  "format_notes": "Awesome-0 generated this from a CLI chat.",  
  "logline": "A seemingly ordinary young man, Link, is thrust into a perilous quest after his uncle is gravely wounded rescuing Princess Zelda. He must gather legendary artifacts, wield the fabled Master Sword, and confront a malevolent wizard to prevent the dark lord Ganon's release and the conquest of their world.",  
  "genre": [  
    "fantasy",  
    "action",  
    "adventure"  
  ],  
  "themes": [  
    "hero's journey",  
    "destiny",  
    "courage in the face of overwhelming evil",  
    "good versus evil",  
    "sacrifice"  
  ],  
}
```

Premise.json

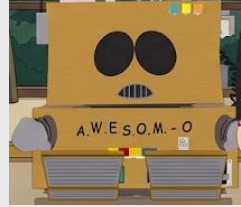
```
"central_conflict": "Link's race against time to understand and embrace his role as a hero, stopping the sorcerer Aghanim from sacrificing Princess Zelda and six other maidens, a ritual that would unleash the ancient evil Ganon from the corrupted Dark World upon the Light World.",
"setting": {
  "primary_time": "High fantasy era, contemporary-feel for characters",
  "primary_places": [
    "Hyrule Castle",
    "Kakariko Village",
    "Eastern Palace",
    "Lost Woods",
    "Dark World"
  ]
},
"protagonists": [
  {
    "name": "Link",
    "role": "Unassuming hero, destined to wield the Master Sword",
    "want": "To save his uncle, rescue Zelda, and ultimately prevent Aghanim and Ganon from destroying Hyrule."
  }
],
"key_antagonist": {
```

Premise.json

```
"protagonists": [  
  {  
    "name": "Link",  
    "role": "Unassuming hero, destined to wield the Master Sword",  
    "want": "To save his uncle, rescue Zelda, and ultimately prevent Aghanim and Ganon from destroying Hyrule."  
  }  
],  
"key_antagonist": {  
  "name": "Aghanim",  
  "role": "Evil sorcerer, Ganon's pawn",  
  "want": "To seal the seven maidens, including Princess Zelda, to open a portal to the Dark World and release Ganon."  
},  
"key_ally": {  
  "name": "Sahasrahla",  
  "role": "Village elder, wise man, guide",  
  "want": "To guide Link to acquire the Master Sword and stop Aghanim's plans to release Ganon."  
},  
"stakes": "The total conquest of the Light World by the dark lord Ganon, resulting in the enslavement or destruction of its inhabitants."  
}
```

Ctrl+L to chat Ctrl+K to generate

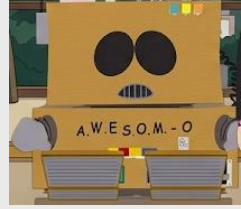
Level 1 Agent: Acts



- A **chat** agent that discusses your movie story arc
 - Arc consists of multiple acts
 - Agent takes premise.json as input for context
- You tell the agent what happens in each act, then ask it to draft the acts, one at a time
- Premise file gives it context for the story arc
- This agent then creates a file **acts.json**

Acts.json

```
{
  "act": 3,
  "label": "Battle Aghanim and the Dark World",
  "approx_pages_note": "This act, encompassing the climax and a major cliffhanger, will likely be around 20-30 pages of a 120-page screenplay.",
  "dramatic_question": "Can Link defeat Aghanim, save Zelda and the other maidens, and prevent Ganon from conquering their world, even when cast into the heart of darkness?",
  "summary": "With the three Pendants collected, Sahasrahla telepathically guides Link to the Lost Woods. There, Link finds the Master Sword embedded in a stone; the pendants activate the legendary blade, allowing him to pull it free and unleashing a wave of energy that clears the woods. Immediately, Zelda telepathically contacts Link with a desperate plea, revealing she's been found and taken back to the castle. Link races back to Hyrule Castle using his Pegasus Boots, battling an army of enchanted soldiers with his newfound sword skills. He confronts Aghanim, who is performing a ritual on a sleeping Zelda. Aghanim zaps Zelda away, revealing he has gathered all seven maidens, descendants of the ancient wise men who sealed Ganon, and plans to break the seal to unleash the dark lord upon the Light World. Link engages Aghanim in a fierce duel, deflecting fireballs with the Master Sword, eventually wounding the sorcerer. In a final act of malice, Aghanim banishes Link to the desolate, ominous Dark World, where he lands on the Great Pyramid. Sahasrahla's telepathic voice once again reaches Link, explaining that the seal is breaking and tasks him with rescuing the seven maidens, starting with one in the Dark Palace, to thwart Ganon's complete release and break the barrier to Aghanim's new lair in Ganon's Tower.",
  "turning_point_end": "Aghanim banishes Link to the corrupted Dark World, setting the stage for a new, desperate quest as the ultimate evil, Ganon, looms large.",
  "must_hit_beats": [
    "Sahasrahla telepathically guides Link to the Master Sword's location in the Lost Woods.",
    "Link finds the Master Sword; the three Pendants activate it, allowing him to pull it from the stone, which releases a wave of energy clearing the woods.",
    "Zelda telepathically contacts Link, revealing she's been captured and taken back to Hyrule Castle.",
    "Link races back to Hyrule Castle, using Pegasus Boots, and battles through a gauntlet of powerful, enchanted soldiers.",
    "Link confronts Aghanim, who zaps Zelda away, having gathered all seven maidens to break Ganon's seal.",
    "Aghanim reveals his plan to unleash Ganon from the Dark World to conquer the Light World.",
    "Link battles Aghanim, deflecting fireballs with the Master Sword, eventually wounding the sorcerer.",
    "Aghanim banishes Link to the Dark World.",
    "Link lands on the Great Pyramid in the desolate Dark World.",
    "Sahasrahla telepathically instructs Link to rescue the seven maidens (including Zelda) to break the barrier to Ganon's Tower, guiding him to the first maiden in the Dark Palace."
  ],
  "midpoint_note": null
}
```

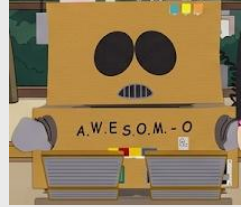


Level 2 Agent: Sequence

- An automated agent (no chat) that writes the sequences of the movie for each act
- Inputs per sequence
 - Premise.json, acts.json – give agent global view of the movie
 - All previous sequences generated so far – give agent local context for what should happen next
- Primary sequence elements
 - Goal – what is the narrative purpose of this sequence
 - Key locations – locations in the sequence
 - Exit beat – how the sequence ends and transitions to next sequence
- This agent then creates a file **sequences.json**

Sequences.json

```
{  
  "project_id": "shadow_of_the_dark_world_20260402_025456",  
  "sequence_count": 8,  
  "note": null,  
  "sequences": [  
    {  
      "id": "SEQ1",  
      "title": "Zelda's Urgent Plea",  
      "act": 1,  
      "goal": "To establish Link's call to adventure, his initial motivation (saving his uncle and Zelda),  
and to equip him with his first tools for the perilous journey ahead.",  
      "emotional_tone": "Urgent, sorrowful, determined",  
      "key_locations": [  
        "Link's Home",  
        "Hyrule Castle (Outer Walls)"  
      ],  
      "exit_beat": "Armed with his uncle's sword and shield, Link steels himself, ready to infiltrate the  
formidable Hyrule Castle and rescue Princess Zelda."  
    },  
  ],  
}
```

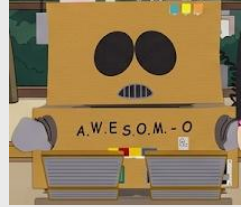


Level 3 Agent: Scene

- **An automated agent (no chat) that writes the scenes of the movie for each sequence**
- **Inputs per scene**
 - **Premise.json, acts.json, sequences.json** – give agent global view of the movie
 - **All scenes generated so far in this sequence** – give agent local context for what should happen next
- **Primary scene elements**
 - **Slug line** – location of the scene
 - **Blocks** – series of actions and dialogues in the scene
- **This agent then creates a file **scenes.json****

Scenes.json

```
"scenes": [  
  {  
    "id": "S0001",  
    "slug_id": "SEQ1-01",  
    "slugline": "INT. LINK'S HOME - NIGHT",  
    "line_start": null,  
    "sequence_id": "SEQ1",  
    "blocks": [  
      {  
        "kind": "action",  
        "text": "A soft glow from a nearby lantern casts long shadows across the simple, familiar room. LINK, a young man with a kind face, sleeps soundly in his bed."  
      },  
      {  
        "kind": "action",  
        "text": "Suddenly, a piercing, desperate WHISPER echoes in his mind, not heard through his ears, but felt deep in his skull."  
      },  
      {  
        "kind": "action",  
        "text": "He jolts awake, eyes wide, disoriented. The whisper intensifies, forming words."  
      },  
      {  
        "kind": "dialogue",  
        "character": "ZELDA (V.O.)",  
        "lines": [  
          "Link... help me... I'm trapped in the castle... Aghanim... has me..."  
        ],  
        "parenthetical": null  
      },  
      {  
        "kind": "action",  
        "text": "Link clutches his head, a jolt of pain, as visions flash through his mind: the cold stone walls of HYRULE CASTLE, Princess ZELDA's terrified face, the menacing silhouette of a SORCERER."  
      },  
    ],  
  },  
]
```



Level 4 Agent: Shots

- An automated agent (no chat) that writes the shots of the movie for each scene
- Inputs per shot
 - Premise.json, acts.json, sequences.json, scenes.json – give agent global view of the movie
 - All shots generated so far in this scene – give agent local context for what should happen next
- Primary shot elements
 - Prompt – What happens in the shot (i.e. what to tell the AI video generator)
 - Duration – how long is the shot (in seconds)
- This agent then creates a file **shots.json**

Shots.json

```
{  
  "scene": 2,  
  "slugline": "EXT. HYRULE CASTLE - OUTER WALLS - NIGHT",  
  "index": 3,  
  "duration": 3,  
  "prompt": "Medium shot, low angle, 35mm lens. Link bursts from  
the dark thicket with a furious, terrified cry, sprinting onto  
the wet stone courtyard. He slides to his knees in front of his  
wounded Uncle, standing between his uncle and the two startled  
Armored Guards who raise their torches and weapons in surprise."  
},
```

Enhancement Agents

- We can improve the agentic flow by using agents to enhance intermediate outputs
- Improve the premise – more details, more complex story, better character motivations and deeper backgrounds
- Improve the acts, sequences, scenes – more details, more interesting beats
- Improve the shots – richer dialogue, more detailed prompt for AI video generator



Coding Session

- Write a short screenplay using Awesome-O
- Add enhancement agents to the agentic flow
- Modify Awesome-O for different document types

